

Abiodun M. Musbaudeen

Department of Economics
Binghamton University (SUNY)

Phone: (607) 760-7889
E-mail: amusbau1@binghamton.edu
abiodunmusbaudeen.github.io

Teaching Statement

I teach students to explain economic decisions, evaluate arguments, and support conclusions with economic reasoning and evidence. I connect intuitive explanations with formal methods and practical examples. Regular practice and discussion give students opportunities to use these ideas and explain their reasoning.

At Binghamton University, I taught **Statistical Methods in Summer 2025**. My teaching assistantships span introductory and intermediate microeconomics, introductory macroeconomics, econometrics, and data analytics. In Introduction to Econometrics, I also lead R instruction. I am prepared to teach these areas, managerial economics, and applied electives in causal inference and panel data.

Responding to Students' Learning Needs

In Introduction to Econometrics, students struggled to understand ordinary least squares (OLS) and the assumptions behind it. I slowed down and returned to the foundations, explaining the ideas behind the derivation. I organized extra classes and additional office hours to give students more time to work through these concepts. Real-life examples connected the mathematical reasoning to an application, which I reinforced in the lab. I then asked students to explain the concepts back to me in their own words. Their follow-up explanations showed improved understanding of the ideas we had revisited. This experience reinforced the value of combining foundational explanations with applications and checking what students could explain themselves.

I assigned weekly homework so students could practice throughout the course and identify difficulties before examinations. I also provided additional practice questions. Following a worked solution and solving a problem independently make different demands on a learner. Regular assignments gave students time to attempt a problem, recognize where they needed help, and return to it with a question.

To support that practice, I created online lecture videos on course topics and difficult concepts and uploaded my slides and lecture notes. A lecture moves at one pace, while students need different amounts of time to work through an idea. Recordings let them pause at a difficult step and revisit the explanation alongside their notes. Providing these materials gave students resources they could use while working independently, when a question might arise after class.

Using Explanations to Examine Understanding

My standard for understanding is straightforward: students explain a concept in their own words and connect a method to its interpretation. In microeconomics, I begin with an economic question before developing the formal argument. When discussing a tax, I ask students to predict its effects, work through the graph, and explain the result in words. Their explanations help me assess whether they understand the economic reasoning behind the diagram.

In R instruction, I work through practical examples that connect data preparation, estimation, and interpretation. I explain the econometric ideas alongside their application in the lab, and students work with reproducible scripts. This connects the course concepts to the steps of an analysis. I use the same check of understanding as in my other instruction: students explain the ideas in their own words. The purpose is to help them understand what the analysis means as well as how to carry it out.

I also created an online collaboration platform where students could discuss difficult concepts with classmates before bringing unresolved questions to me. The purpose was to make explaining an idea part of learning it. Putting a question into words and considering another student's approach offer ways to examine one's own understanding. I complemented this space with flexible office hours and encouraged students to contact me when questions arose. Together, these practices made room for both peer discussion and individual support.

Across these activities, I listen for how students connect the problem, the method, and the conclusion. Their explanations provide evidence about what needs further attention, alongside homework and examinations.

Building Confidence and Purpose

My industry experience gives these expectations a practical basis. At First Bank of Nigeria, I developed models of customer dormancy and transaction-channel choice to support retention and service decisions. At Konga, I led a data science and engineering team and translated customer-segmentation findings into recommendations for management. These roles required connecting analytical results to decisions made by other people. In my teaching, I therefore emphasize interpretation, documentation, and clear communication. A reproducible script needs to be understandable to someone who did not write it, and an estimate needs an explanation of what it means. These habits prepare students for research and for workplaces where colleagues rely on their analysis.

I build confidence by giving students practice, explanations they can revisit, and opportunities to work through difficulties with others. My aim is for students to approach unfamiliar questions with both independence and judgment: explaining their reasoning, recognizing its limits, and seeking help or further evidence when needed.